

Countdown to True Wireless Broadband 2, 2.5, 3, 3.5... 4G!

Always-on, mobile Internet connections have become common, but the current generation of 2G and 2.5G hardly classify as broadband. While 3G and 3.5G technologies do mark a beginning, the upcoming 4G technologies—namely 802.16m WiMAX and LTE Release 10 (and upwards)—are truly broadband wireless access (BWA)



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Of late, there appears to be more talk about *looters* than routers, and amidst burgeoning news about money made and lost, the real impact of 3G, if any, and the incumbent 4G technologies already on their way have

been completely lost to all but serious tech-watchers. To the extent that the general population in India seems predominantly unaware of a relatively new term called broadband wireless access (BWA) that is being discussed extensively not just in developed nations but in the developing nations too. In fact, BWA is being positioned as a major shift in telecommunications and

experts claim it could be more relevant than current broadband technologies for those at the bottom of the pyramid.

So, what is this BWA all about? Is it merely a wireless local area networking technology like Wi-Fi? Or, is it mobile Internet akin to code division multiple access (CDMA) or general packet radio service (GPRS)? Is it a second-generation (2G), third-